

Firefly Festival



2-6 Players

60 Minutes

Ages 12+

Dusk settles over the archipelago and the first lanterns are lit. Build bridges between the islands, raise pagodas toward the sky and call the most spectacular festivals the islands have ever seen. Whoever lights the night with the most dazzling celebration will earn glory - but misfortune stalks those who grow too bold.

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Rulebook version 9
Approximately 15 minutes per player



Overview

In Firefly Festival, players compete to build bridges between islands, raise pagodas toward the sky, and call the most spectacular festivals. Workers spread across the archipelago, and whoever lights the night with the most dazzling celebration will earn glory - but misfortune stalks those who grow too bold.

Each turn you take one **Main Action** - building bridges, raising pagodas, moving your workers or holding festivals - and you may add one **Secondary Action**: completing goals, taking the Crow, or playing a Lucky Fish. When the festivals run out, the player with the most points wins.

Components

Common Components



1 Game Board - double sided: one side for 2-3 players, the other for 4-6



15 Sōrin tokens - placed on top of pagodas to mark scoring



50 coins



70 goal cards (68 mm × 45 mm) - private and public goals



30 unique player power cards (80 mm × 120 mm)



1 Crow token



18 island tiles

Per Player



20 bridge tokens



12 stackable pagoda floors



12 meeples



3 fish tokens



1 score marker



2 player aid cards (80 mm × 120 mm)

The Archipelago

Islands and water lanes in the middle, the score track around the edge, and the goal displays along the bottom



Setup

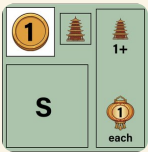
- 1. Place the board in the centre of the table.
- 2. Take a number of island tiles based on the player count:

Island Size	2-3 Players	4+ Players
Start (Orange)	2	2
Small (Green)	4	6
Medium (Yellow)	3	6
Large (Red)	3	4
Total	12	18

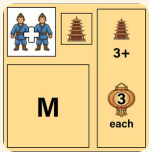
- 3. In your first game, place the 2 starting tiles on the islands in the top left corner of the board and the bottom right of the board. In later games, for a variable setup, you may shuffle the starting tiles in with the other tiles.
- 4. Shuffle the remaining island tiles and randomly place them on the map.
- 5. Select 4 public goal types from the 7 available. For each type, sort the 6 cards in ascending order (1 on top, 6 on bottom) and place the stack on a public goal space at the bottom of the board.
- 6. Shuffle the private goal deck and place it face down on the marked spot on the board.
- 7. Deal each player 2 Private Goal cards. Players may look at their own goals but must keep them secret from others.
- 8. Place the Crow token in the Crow Goal space on the board.
- 9. Each player places 2 of their workers on each starter island.
- 10. Each player receives 5 coins.
- 11. Each player places their 3 fish in front of them.
- 12. Place your score marker on the 0 space of the score track.



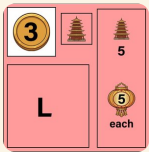
Start



Small



Medium



Large

Every island tile shows its worker capacity, its pagoda reward, the pagoda height a festival needs, and the points each piece scores there

- 13. Count out a number of Sōrin tokens based on the player count, shown below. Place them next to the main game board where everyone can easily see them. Return the remainder to the box.

Players	Sōrin
2	6
3	8
4	10
5	12
6	15

- 14. Determine the first player randomly. Play proceeds clockwise.

Turn Structure

On your turn, choose exactly **one Main Action**. You may also perform **one Secondary Action**, either before or after your main action, but only once per turn.

The 4 Main Actions

-  Build a Bridge
-  Build a Pagoda
-  Move 3
-  Hold a Festival

The Secondary Actions

-  Complete a Public Goal
-  Complete a Private Goal
-  Take the Crow
-  Use a Lucky Fish





Build a Bridge

Main Action

Bridges connect islands, allowing workers to move between them, and count toward Festival majorities and scoring.

Bridges must be built in a **straight line** between two islands, with no turns or crossings.

To build a bridge, you must have a **worker on either island**.

Pay **1 coin per segment** of bridge. You must complete the entire bridge in one action - it is not permitted to only build part of a bridge. If you cannot afford to pay for the bridge, or you do not have enough bridge pieces left in your supply, then you may not build a bridge.

Bridges can **never be moved**.

Up to **3 bridges** can be built between a pair of islands, depending on the layout of the map. It is permitted for the same player to build multiple bridges between the same pair of islands.

Free Movement

After building a bridge, you may move any of your workers already on the two connected islands across the new bridge to the other island.

Water Rewards

Dotted around the map are rewards on water tiles. If you build a bridge piece on a reward, you immediately gain the reward.

Pay first, collect after!

You gain the reward **after** building the bridge. You cannot use rewards gained by building a bridge to pay for it!

Icon	Water Reward
	Gain 2 coins
	Recruit a new worker - they must be placed on either starter island
	Draw a new Private Goal
	Gain 5 points

End of Game Bridge Scoring

At the end of the game, points will be awarded for building long chains of islands connected by bridges - see **End of the Game**.



Move 3

Main Action

Moving around the board is very strategic - it gets you in the right place for festivals and for building.

As your main action, you may make **3 movements** of your workers. This can be the same worker 3 times, or 3 workers 1 time each, or any combination in between.

To move, trace a path from the worker's current location to their destination island. Workers only move along bridges. A chain of connected bridges belonging to a **single player** counts as **1 move**. This means that a network of bridges owned by the same player can let you travel a long distance with a single move.

If the bridges belong to you, there is no charge to use them. If the bridge belongs to another player, you must **pay them 1 coin for each bridge** you use - that is per bridge, the length of the bridge is not relevant. If you cannot afford to pay for moving, then you cannot move.

Island Capacity

Each island has a capacity based on its size - Small: 4 workers, Medium: 5, Large: 6. It is forbidden to exceed this limit at the end of your turn. You may move through islands that are at capacity, but you may not stop. The island capacity is shown on the island tile.



Small



Medium



Large

Worked Example - moving and paying tolls

Kenji's first movement runs along his own network of three linked bridges, crossing four islands - because they are all his, that whole journey is **1 move** and costs nothing.

His second movement crosses one of Mei's bridges, so he pays **Mei 1 coin**, however long that bridge is. His third and last movement crosses another of hers for **1 more coin**. Three movements spent, 2 coins paid - and no worker may finish on an island that is already at capacity.



Build a Pagoda

Main Action

Pagodas give you an immediate reward and are very important for festivals.

Pagodas are built on the designated spot on islands. Pagodas can **never** be built on the starting islands.

To build a pagoda, you must have a **worker on the island**.

Place your pagoda floor onto the island, or on top of any pagoda floors already on the island. Multiple players may contribute floors to the same pagoda - a pagoda can have pieces from many different players.

Pagodas have a **maximum height of 5** - you may never place a sixth piece on a pagoda.

Building a pagoda is **free**. Each island has a pagoda reward shown on the island. As soon as you build the pagoda floor, immediately claim the reward shown on that island:

Icon	Pagoda Reward	Island
	Gain 1 coin	Small
	Gain 2 coins	Small
	Recruit 2 new workers - they can be placed on either starter island	Medium
	Draw a new Private Goal	Medium
	Gain 3 coins	Large
	Gain 4 coins	Large

Sealed with a Sōrin

When a Festival is held, a Sōrin marker is placed on top of the pagoda, sealing it permanently. No further floors may be added to a sealed pagoda.





Hold a Festival

Main Action

Festivals are how you score most of your points in the game. Keep an eye on the islands as the pagodas grow and the bridges multiply.

For a festival to be called, **all** of these requirements must be met:

- **Minimum pagoda height.** Each island has a minimum number of pagoda floors that must be placed before a festival can be called. This is displayed on the island: Small 1, Medium 3, Large 5.
- **Enough bridges.** The number of bridges connecting to the island must equal or exceed the height of the pagoda. This means the number of different bridges connected to the island - the size of the bridges does not matter.
- **A worker present.** You must have a worker on the island - someone has to run the show!
- **Majority.** You must have the majority of all pieces on the island - that is, pagoda pieces, bridges and workers. You may call a festival even if you tie with another player for the majority.

If all these requirements are met, we hold a festival! Scoring one is described on the next page.



The lanterns are lit and the whole archipelago comes to watch

Scoring a Festival

Immediately place a **Sōrin token** on top of the island's pagoda to indicate it has been scored. The island cannot be scored again and no more pagoda pieces can be added to the island.

Points are now awarded to every player for every worker, pagoda floor and bridge they have on the island - for bridges, it is per bridge; the length of the bridge is not relevant. Each island displays one point value (ranging 1-2 for Small islands, 3-4 for Medium, 5-6 for Large): every piece scores that many points for its owner.



The Firefly Bonus

Next, we award the firefly bonus! For every worker on the island, the person who called the festival gains **2 points**. In addition, look at every other island directly connected to the festival island by a bridge - the person who called the festival gains **2 points** for every worker on those islands as well.

No points are awarded for workers near the festival island but not directly connected to it - they couldn't enjoy the fireworks without standing on a bridge.

Finally, any player who has a worker on the island takes back all their Lucky Fish - see **Use a Lucky Fish**.

The last Sōrin

One way the game can end is if all the Sōrin tokens have been placed. If the Festival places the last Sōrin, the game ends at the end of the current player's turn and we proceed to final scoring - see **End of the Game**.



SCORING

- 1

All players score for each component they have on the island.

 +  + 
each

- 2

The Host scores 2VP for every worker on the island on connected adjacent islands.


- 3

Cap the Pagoda. It cannot score again.


- 4

Anybody who participated in the Festival takes back all their Lucky Fish.



The player aid repeats this sequence

Worked Example - a Medium island festival

Mei calls a festival on a Medium island with a point value of 3. Its pagoda is 3 floors tall, 3 bridges reach the island, Mei has a worker there and she holds the majority of pieces - every requirement is met.

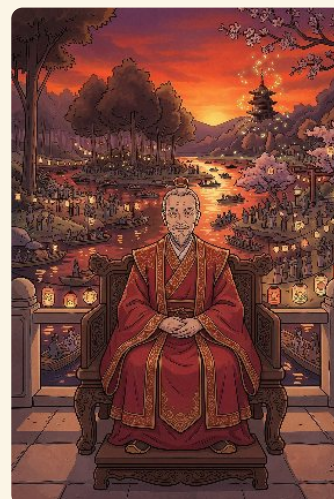
Island scoring: Mei owns 2 workers, 2 pagoda floors and 1 bridge there: $5 \text{ pieces} \times 3 = \mathbf{15 \text{ points}}$. Kenji owns 1 worker, 1 pagoda floor and 2 bridges: $4 \text{ pieces} \times 3 = \mathbf{12 \text{ points}}$.

Firefly bonus (caller only): 3 workers stand on the island (Mei's 2 and Kenji's 1) and 2 more workers stand on islands directly connected by bridge: $5 \text{ workers} \times 2 = \mathbf{10 \text{ points}}$ for Mei.

Mei scores $15 + 10 = \mathbf{25 \text{ points}}$; Kenji scores **12**. Both had workers at the festival, so both take back all their Lucky Fish. Mei then places a Sōrin token on the pagoda, and that island is finished for the rest of the game.



Only the islands joined by a bridge share in the fireflies





Complete a Public Goal

Secondary

Public Goals are limited, but worth a lot of points. You should try to complete as many as possible!

At the bottom of the board are 4 public goals. Within each stack, the cards are arranged in increasing difficulty and also increasing rewards.

If you meet the requirements of the goal, you may claim it. Immediately gain the points shown on the card and put the card in your supply.

This immediately reveals the next card in the stack. It will have a similar goal, but of increased difficulty and reward.

One goal per turn

You may only claim **1 goal per turn**, even if you already meet the requirements of the new goal revealed.



Every festival needs somebody to fund it



Complete a Private Goal

Secondary

Private Goals are a way of scoring a lot of uncontested points. Try to score Private Goals on turns where you might not be able to complete a public goal.

Each player is given 2 private goals at the start of the game. On your turn, if you have met the requirements of the card, you may complete it and gain the points shown on the card.

You do **not** draw a replacement card. The only way of getting new Private Goals is through the rewards gained by building bridges and placing pagodas.

Remember, you may only claim **1 goal per turn** - see **One goal per turn** opposite.



Kept close, revealed only when scored

Summary of Goals

Four of these seven public goal types are used each game - the card shown is always the easiest of its stack of six



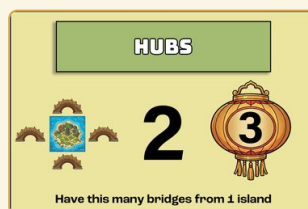
Empire

Pagodas on different islands



Architect

Bridges of increasing size



Hubs

Many bridges from one island



Merchant

Have lots of money



Tower

Build tall pagodas



Diversity

Workers on many islands



Ready to Go

An army of workers



Private Goals

Secret - two at setup



Take the Crow

Secondary Action

The sound of the crow can be a harbinger of doom. Or is it just a lucky break?

As a secondary action, you may take the Crow token. You must have at least 4 accumulated points to take the Crow. You immediately **pay 4 points**. If you have not yet accrued 4 points, then you may not take the Crow.

If another player has already taken the Crow, you take it from them. You still pay the penalty of 4 points.

When you take the Crow, you must choose to take either **3 coins**, or **recruit 2 workers** to either starter island.

In addition, at the start of each subsequent turn, you take **2 coins** from the bank.

Beware the final crow

At the end of the game, if you still have the Crow, you **lose 10 points**.

Worked Example - is the Crow worth it?

Mei takes the Crow on her fourth turn, dropping from 11 points to 7, and chooses 3 coins. From then on she collects 2 coins at the start of every turn - eight turns of income is 16 extra coins.

If nobody takes it from her, that Crow still costs her **10 points** at the end, 14 in total. Those coins need to have bought her more than 14 points of bridges, festivals and goals - or she needs Kenji to feel greedy before the last lantern goes out.



Use a Lucky Fish

Secondary Action

Fish are considered lucky, and playing them at the right time can change the game dramatically - but they are expensive!

Each player starts the game with 3 fish in front of them. As a secondary action, you may place one of your fish on the next slot of the Fish area. These slots are not blocking - many players can be on the same slot.

You must immediately pay the price shown on the slot. If you are unable to pay, you may not place your fish. The price of placing fish increases with each fish - **3 coins**, then **5 coins**, then **7 coins**.

If you do not have any fish in your supply, you may not take this action.

After placing your fish, you may immediately perform **one of the 4 main actions**: Build a Bridge, Build a Pagoda, Move 3, or Hold a Festival.

The fish is your secondary action

Using your Lucky Fish counts as your Secondary Action. You may not also complete a goal or take the Crow this turn.

Whenever you have a worker on an island where a festival is held, regardless of who calls the festival, you take **all your fish** back into your supply. This is true even if somebody else called it - so standing where a rival is about to celebrate has its compensations.



End of the Game

Be watchful as the pagodas rise and the Festivals are held. The game could end sooner than you realise.

The end of the game is triggered when **any** of the following events happen:

- The last Sōrin is placed and a festival is held - score the festival as normal.
- A player places their last pagoda piece.
- All the public goals are completed.

The game ends at the conclusion of the current player's turn.

Final Scoring

Total all points accumulated during play. The player who holds the Crow immediately **loses 10 points**.

Island Chain Scoring

Players then count up the highest number of islands they can connect using bridges of their own colour, without passing through the same island twice. Consult the table shown on the map and gain the points shown.

The player who has the **longest network** scores an additional **15 points**.

Victory!

The player with the most points wins. If there's a tie, the player with the most coins wins. If there's still a tie, players rejoice in their shared victory.

Unique Player Powers

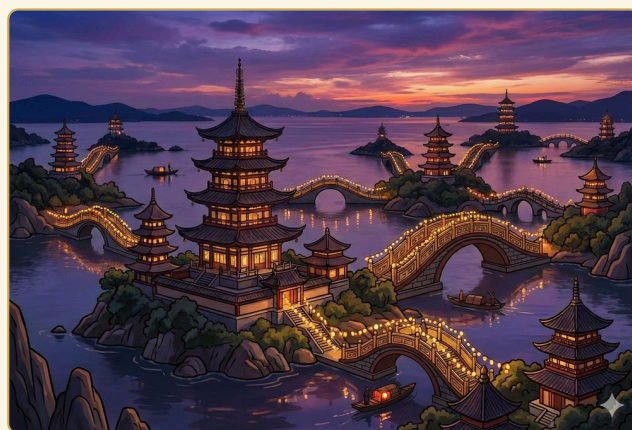
Unique player powers give the game a new twist and challenge you to play the game in different ways.

Once you are familiar with the game, you may like to play with unique player powers. Shuffle the deck of powers at the start of the game and deal each player 2 cards. Each player secretly selects one card and discards the other. Players then reveal their cards and read out their powers for the other players.

Most cards have an ongoing power, but some cards alter the starting resources in a player's supply.

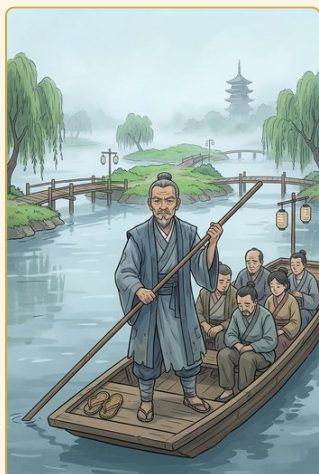
Thirty ways to celebrate

The powers reward very different plans - some want a sprawling bridge network, others a single towering pagoda or a full purse. Listen carefully as they are read out, because your rivals' powers hint at where they are heading.



One last night of lanterns before the tally

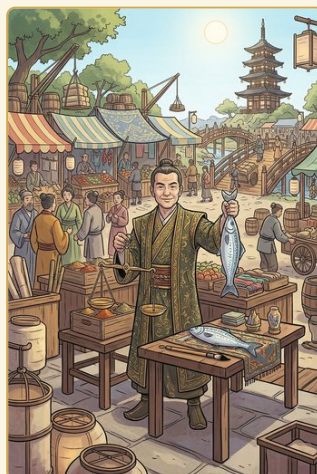
A Few of the Powers - deal two, keep one, reveal it to the table



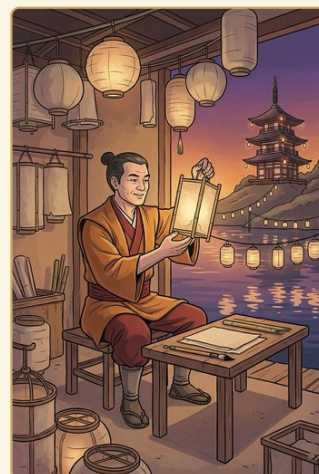
The Ferryman



The Architect



The Merchant



The Lantern Maker

Quick Reference

Your Turn

One **Main Action**, plus optionally one **Secondary Action** before or after it.

Main Actions

- **Build a Bridge** - worker on either island; pay 1 coin per segment; straight lines only; collect water rewards after building; free movement across the new bridge.
- **Build a Pagoda** - worker on the island; free; maximum height 5; never on starter islands; claim the island's pagoda reward immediately.
- **Move 3** - three movements; your own connected network is 1 free move; pay the owner 1 coin per rival bridge used; respect island capacity (4 / 5 / 6) at the end of your turn.
- **Hold a Festival** - minimum pagoda height (1 / 3 / 5); bridges at least equal to pagoda height; your worker present; majority of pieces, ties allowed.

Secondary Actions

- **Complete a Public Goal** - claim the revealed card of a stack you satisfy.
- **Complete a Private Goal** - play a private goal you satisfy; no replacement drawn.
- **Take the Crow** - pay 4 points; take 3 coins or 2 workers; then 2 coins income each turn; -10 points if you still hold it at the end.
- **Use a Lucky Fish** - pay 3 / 5 / 7 coins, then immediately take a main action.

Only **one goal per turn** may be claimed, and the Lucky Fish uses up your secondary action.

Festival Scoring

- Seal the pagoda with a Sōrin token - that island is finished.
- Every player scores the island's point value for each worker, pagoda floor and bridge they own there.
- The caller gains 2 points per worker on the island and on every island directly connected by a bridge.
- Everyone with a worker present takes back all their Lucky Fish.

Game End Triggers

- The last Sōrin is placed by a festival.
- A player places their last pagoda piece.
- All public goals are completed.

Finish the current player's turn, then score.

Final Scoring

- The Crow holder loses 10 points.
- Score your longest chain of islands joined by your own bridges, using the table on the map; the longest network of all gains a further 15 points.
- Most points wins; ties are broken by the most coins.

Firefly Festival

Icon Key



Coin



Points



Worker



Bridge



Pagoda floor



Sōrin token



Festival



Public goal



Private goal



The Crow



Lucky Fish



Recruit workers

Light the lanterns, ring the bell, and let the fireflies decide.